Santuri DNA: Music Industry and Culture

> **How can artists take part in musical exchange while protecting context, credit and community?**

Work through these six tasks with a partner. You need a notebook, a pen, your voice, and one phone per pair for a short task in Task 4. Total time is about 3 hours.

BEFORE YOU START

Decide who is **Partner A** and who is **Partner B**. You swap roles in every task, so both of you talk and both of you listen.

- **Talker:** explains, answers, thinks out loud.
- **Asker:** asks the questions in the task, and keeps asking "How do you know that?" and "Can you give an example?"

PAIR RULES

1. Give an example before an opinion.
2. "I assumed..." is a strong thing to say, not a weak one.
3. Write your partner's best idea down, not just your own.
4. Disagree with the idea, then build on it.

1

20 min

Listen and Ask

People, place, purpose, tools.

Pick two or three short sounds, or use your own examples: a song from home, a sound from your neighbourhood, a track you love, something you've made. For each one, take turns asking each other these four questions. Write one answer for each in your notebook.

1. **People:** Who made this first? Who makes it now?
2. **Place:** Where was it made? What kind of event or room was it for?
3. **Purpose:** Was it for dancing, mourning, praying, working, celebrating?
4. **Tools:** What shaped the sound? A hand-built instrument, a cheap phone, a big sound system, software on a borrowed laptop?

EXAMPLE

Singeli from Dar es Salaam. People: young producers and MCs. Place: street parties. Purpose: dancing, very fast. Tools: cheap software and loud sound systems.

TALK ABOUT IT TOGETHER · 5 MIN

If this sound turned up in a track made in London or Berlin tomorrow, what should travel with it? Write one sentence you both agree on:

> *"When a sound moves, it should take with it..."*

2

30 min

Influence Map

What you know, what you assume, what to check.

On your own (8 min). Write your project name in the middle of a page. Draw three branches. On each, write one influence: an artist, a scene, a teacher, a technique, a place or a tool. Under each, write:

- **I know:** something you can point to.
- **I assume:** something you believe but haven't checked.
- **To check:** who or what could confirm it.

EXAMPLE

Influence	I know	I assume	To check
Amapiano log drums	I learned them from YouTube tutorials	It started in Pretoria townships	Find an interview with a South African producer
Kayamba shaker	I built one in Instrument Makers Lab	It's from the Mijikenda	Ask the lab tutor which communities play it, and how
My teacher's mixing style	They told me to cut the low mids	Nothing	Credit them in my notes

INFLUENCE WALK · 12 MIN

Stand up and walk slowly together while you talk. A explains their map for 3 minutes. B asks only questions:

- "How do you know that?"
- "Who could you ask?"

- "Is there a person behind this influence who should be named?"

Then swap.

Fix it (3 min). If your partner's questions showed something you only *assumed*, move it to *To check* and write who you'll ask.

3

30 min

Consent and Credit Cases

Decide together: permission, credit, documentation.

First, learn four words. Use them to name what's happening in each case.

Word	What it means
Inspiration	You take an idea or a feeling, not the recording or the exact notes.
Collaboration	You make it together and share the credit (and any money).
Sampling	You use part of someone else's recording. It needs permission.
Appropriation	You take without context, credit or consent, often from people with less power.

How to work. Take the cases in turns: A reads one aloud, B answers first, then A adds or disagrees. Agree together and write one line per case. Do at least four cases.

> *"This is _____. We need permission from _____. We should credit _____. We should write down _____."*

A. The river song

You record a woman singing while washing clothes by the river in your home village. You want her voice as the hook. She said "yes, record", but didn't know it would be released. *Is that consent?*

B. The old benga record

You sample 4 bars from a 1970s Kenyan benga record you found at a market. The band is no longer around. *Who do you ask? What if you can't find anyone?*

C. One take, no contract

A friend plays nyatiti on your track in one take, "just for vibes". Six months later the track is popular. *What did they agree to on the day?*

D. The sample pack

A producer in Europe offers good money for "authentic African field recordings" for a sample pack. *Who is in those recordings, and will they ever know?*

E. The viral remix

You remix a classmate's track from this course without asking and post it on TikTok. It goes viral. *Does being classmates change anything?*

F. The sacred chant

Your track uses a chant from a ceremony. An elder says it should never be played in clubs. *Does the community's rule matter even if the law allows it?*

Hint. A recording has two owners: whoever owns **the song** (words and melody, called *publishing*) and whoever owns **the recording itself** (the *master*). A sample usually needs a yes from both.

4

35 min

Follow the Release

Who owns it, who gets paid, who gets forgotten.

THE TRACK

"Mvua" by a Nairobi student. The singer wrote the lyrics and melody. A producer made the beat. It uses a kayamba loop recorded in Kilifi, with permission. It's released on Spotify, Boomplay and YouTube through a distributor, played on radio, and used in a TikTok trend.

Role	What they do
Songwriter	Writes the words and melody. Owns the song (publishing) unless they sign it away.
Performer	Sings or plays on the recording.
Producer	Makes the beat and shapes the sound.
Master owner	Paid for the recording, so owns the recording itself.
Sample source	The person heard in the sample (here, the kayamba player).
Publisher	Helps the songwriter register the song and collect songwriting money, for a share.
Collecting society	Collects money when music is played on radio, in clubs and in public, only for people registered with them.

Role	What they do
Distributor	Uploads the track to platforms. Needs correct names in the metadata.
Platform	Spotify, Boomplay, YouTube, TikTok. Keeps a cut and pays the rest to whoever the metadata names.
Listener	Streams, shares, dances. Where the money starts.

Talk it through. Take turns: A asks the question, B answers, then swap for the next one.

1. Who owns the *song* in "Mvua"? Who owns the *recording*?
2. Who paid for the studio session? Why does that matter?
3. What did the kayamba player agree to, and where is it written down?
4. The radio plays "Mvua". Who gets paid, and what do they have to do first?
5. The distributor's metadata only lists the singer. Who loses out?
6. A TikTok trend uses the track. Who earns, and who is invisible?

CHECK THE CREDITS · 10 MIN

Pick a song you both like. One phone between you is enough.

1. **Guess first.** Without looking anything up, write down who you think worked on what: who wrote it, who produced it, who sings or plays on it, who mixed it, and who owns the recording (the label).
2. **Find the real credits.** On Spotify or Apple Music, open the song's menu (⋯) and choose "View credits". You can also check the YouTube description, or the sleeve or booklet if you have the CD or vinyl.
3. **Compare.** What did you get right? Who is in the credits that you didn't expect? Who do you think worked on it but isn't named, like a session player, an engineer or the source of a sample?

DRAW IT · 5 MIN

Together, draw "Mvua" in the middle of a page and the roles around it. Draw arrows for where the money goes. Circle the role that's easiest to forget.

5 Interview Each Other

Your final project, from vague to clear.

40 min

Take a short private moment first. Write one line only you will see:

> *"Before today I assumed _____. Now I think _____, because _____."*

Interview (10 min each). A interviews B using the seven questions below and writes B's answers in B's notebook. Then swap. If an answer sounds like the "vague" column, ask again.

Ask your partner	Vague	Clear
Who is it for?	"Everyone."	"Young people at Santuri open decks and my cousins in Kisumu."
What will it be?	"A song."	"One 4-minute track and a 60-second live video on my phone."
Who are you working with?	"Maybe some friends."	"My classmate on vocals. I'll ask her about credit this week."
What sounds will you use?	"Some samples."	"Two field recordings from the weekend fieldwork and a kayamba I built."
Where do those sounds come from?	"African vibes."	"Coastal rhythms I grew up with in Malindi, mixed with Nairobi club music."
Who owns what?	"Me."	"I own the beat. Vocals 50/50 with my classmate. Samples credited to the people recorded."
What can you really finish?	"A full EP."	"One finished track and a credit sheet by the final session."

Write (10 min, on your own). Turn your answers into one paragraph. Start with *"My final project is..."* and end with *"I will know it is finished when..."*.

6

35 min

Ethics Check, Log and Commitment

Make it clear, write it down, say it out loud.

Ethics check (15 min). A reads their paragraph aloud twice, slowly. B listens for these four things and asks about anything missing:

- **Credit:** Is everyone in the project named?
- **Consent:** Has each person said yes, and to what?

- **Context:** Is it clear where the sounds come from?
- **Release:** Is it clear where people will hear it and what they'll be told?

B then says *"One thing missing is..."* and *"A clearer sentence would be..."*. A writes the suggestion down word for word. Swap.

EXAMPLE

A: "I'll use some sounds from my grandmother."

B: "One thing missing is what she agreed to. A clearer sentence would be: 'I'll use two recordings of my grandmother singing, which she agreed to on 2 November, credited as Mama Achieng.'"

Start your source-and-contributor log (10 min). Draw this table on a fresh page and fill at least two rows. Help your partner fill theirs. Take a photo of it on your phone so you don't lose it.

Sound or contribution	Who / where from	Permission (how, when)	Credit as	Still to check
Kayamba loop	Me, instrument I built at IML	Mine	"Kayamba: [my name]"	Nothing
Vocal hook	Classmate, Nairobi	Asked in person on 30 Oct, agreed 50/50	"Vocals: [name]"	Write the split down and both sign

SAY IT OUT LOUD · 2 MIN

Tell your partner, then the group:

> *"My project is _____, for _____, and the next decision I need to make is _____."*

This weekend. Do *Weekend Assignment 04: Contextual Sampling Fieldwork*. Record or source three culturally situated sounds with permission, context and credit notes. Make one change to a sound that keeps where it comes from recognisable, and one that hides it. Bring the files and your log to Lesson 13.